

PORTFOLIO | CASE STUDY 01

THE TSUBAKIMORI

INSTAGRAM MARKETING CASE STUDY

A Calm Design-led Base
Between Narita, Tokyo and Boso

INDEPENDENT CONCEPT PROJECT
OCTOBER 2026

HATTORI ICHIDAI — ATLAS TO PARADISE

PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY — HOTEL & TOURISM INSTAGRAM MARKETING

INSTAGRAM MARKETING
CASE STUDY | ENGLISH EDITION

ABOUT THIS STUDY

An independent case study based on public data — scope and conventions

This document is an independent portfolio case study of the official Instagram account of THE TSUBAKIMORI Hotel & Residence (Chiba City, Japan), built **entirely from public information**. It covers audit, diagnosis, positioning, content design, a 30-day operating plan and a KPI framework.

It was not commissioned, supervised or approved by the hotel, and it does not represent official account management results. No revenue or booking growth is claimed anywhere in this document; business effects are framed strictly as hypotheses to be tested.

— How to read the data

PUBLIC DATA Figures and facts verified from the public profile and 26 public posts, retrieved on 30 October 2026.

HYPOTHESIS Strategic proposals and estimates, explicitly marked as items to be validated with real data.

NOT AVAILABLE Metrics visible only in the account owner's Insights (reach, impressions, saves, etc.). No figures are invented for these.

2,234	56
Followers (as of 30 Oct 2026)	Total posts (profile count)
25.7	**1**
Average likes, last 90 days (13 posts)	Total comments, last 90 days

Scope: public profile plus 26 retrievable public posts (6 May – 25 Oct 2026). The sample covers all posts in the last-90-day window (1 Aug – 30 Oct). The ~1.2% figure is average likes divided by followers — a reference ratio only, not a reach-based engagement rate.

— Property snapshot

Property	THE TSUBAKIMORI Hotel & Residence, Chiba City
Opened	7 May 2026 — Chiba City's first boutique hotel
Access	10 min walk from JR Chiba Station / 2 min from Chiba Park Station, beside Chiba Park
Instagram	@the_tsubakimori_hotel

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20 chapters plus appendix — identical structure and figures in the Japanese and English editions

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All figures in this document are based on public data retrieved on 30 October 2026. Property details, prices, transport, facilities and event information should be re-verified against primary sources before publication.

CHAPTER 01

OVERVIEW

A six-month-old account: real assets, and the next move

THE TSUBAKIMORI Hotel & Residence opened in May 2026 beside Chiba Park. Its Instagram account launched with the hotel and grew to 2,234 followers and 56 posts in about six months — a solid start for a new property.

Over the last 90 days, however, average likes have fallen to 25.7 per post and total comments stand at just one. The strongest reactions were not room announcements: they were the opening post and the stay plans tied to YohaS, the night art festival in Chiba Park. The public data tells a clear story — **this audience responds to experiences connected to the area, not to property notices alone.**

The question of this case study is simple: how does the account move from selling rooms to proposing a stay in Chiba? The following chapters answer it across positioning, content, operations and measurement.

— What this document sets out

- A quantitative audit from public data (Chapter 02)
- Repositioning as a base between Narita, Tokyo and Boso (Chapter 03)
- Ten executable content concepts and a 30-day plan (Chapters 10–11)
- A KPI and measurement framework for verification (Chapters 14–15)



A room overlooking the park's greenery is the property's strongest content asset (project concept visual).

154
Top post likes (YohaS stay plan, 1 Jun 2026)

~1.2%
Avg. likes / followers (reference ratio)

CHAPTER 02

CHALLENGE

Public-data snapshot (retrieved 30 October 2026) PUBLIC DATA

— Last 90 days (1 Aug – 30 Oct 2026)

Metric	Value	Reading
Posts	13	Roughly one per week
Likes: total / average / median	334 / 25.7 / 24	Down from the opening period
Top post	56 (Reel)	"Monorail Day" concept
Total comments	1	No conversation loop

— Format mix (26-post sample)



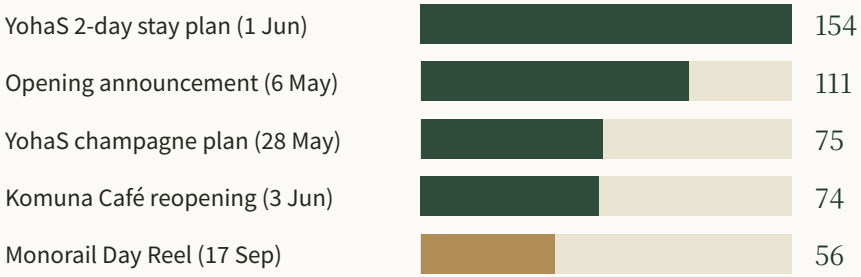
Across the full sample: average likes 35.2, median 23, maximum 154. Reactions concentrate in the opening period (May–June) and in event-linked plans.

— Posting-time skew



Eight of the 26 posts went out in the 3 a.m. hour, suggesting scheduled posts are set to overnight slots. Whether this suppresses reach cannot be proven from public data — reach itself is NOT AVAILABLE. Chapter 15 designs the test.

— Top posts by likes



— The challenge, defined

- **Repeatability** — the event-linked success (154 likes) has not been turned into a recurring format tied to the local events calendar
- **No conversation** — near-zero comments; no question design or Stories mechanics to start dialogue
- **Discoverability** — too little save- and share-worthy "how to spend time in Chiba" content to reach non-followers
- **No measurement loop** — owner-only metrics are not part of operations, so improvement cannot be verified

CHAPTER 03

POSITIONING

From "a hotel in Chiba" to a base for the journey HYPOTHESIS



A Calm, Design-Led Base Between Narita, Tokyo and Boso.

Beyond Tokyo. Discover Chiba.

The recommended positioning reframes the property: not a hotel that happens to be in Chiba City, but **a base for exploring Chiba** — calm, design-led, and connected to Narita, Tokyo and the Boso Peninsula.

— Why "base" works

- It converts transit demand — pre- and post-flight nights, Tokyo itineraries — into an entry point for a Chiba stay
- Bundling the park, the monorail and local food turns one night into a credible two-night proposition
- "Calm and design" gives travellers a preference-based reason to choose, outside price competition

This positioning is a strategic hypothesis. It should be validated against booking demographics and Instagram audience data — both currently NOT AVAILABLE — and revised if the data disagrees.

CHAPTER 04

TARGET AUDIENCE

Priority markets are set as hypotheses and verified in Insights HYPOTHESIS

Taiwan

A repeat-visitor market that combines Tokyo with nearby excursions. Traditional Chinese content and clear Narita-arrival routing are the assumed levers.

United States & Canada

Longer stays and wide-area itineraries. "A calm base before / after Tokyo" framing, two-night propositions and complete English content are key.

Australia & United Kingdom

Independent travellers with high sensitivity to design and local experience. Editorial content on the park, food and neighbourhood walks is expected to travel.

— Domestic audience

- Capital-region residents seeking a short weekend retreat, aligned with Chiba Park's seasonal events
- Event- and concert-driven stays in Chiba City
- Business use and workations that value a quiet environment

— How priorities get decided

Country priorities are hypotheses at this stage. Confirming them requires Instagram audience data (country / region) cross-checked against the nationality mix of actual bookings. A first review is scheduled after 30 days of operation, together with the KPI review in Chapter 14.

No external market-size figures are cited in this document; such numbers are treated as items to verify against primary sources before publication.

CHAPTER 05

AUDIENCE INSIGHT

Before booking, what is the traveller actually deciding? HYPOTHESIS

International travellers rarely choose a Chiba hotel as a "substitute for Tokyo". They choose it while assembling an itinerary: the night after landing at Narita, a quiet night after Tokyo, the night before the Boso Peninsula. The unit of decision is not the room — it is **how easily the whole trip comes together**.

The public data agrees: event-and-stay plans outperformed property announcements. Travellers do not save a list of facilities; they save a picture of time spent, and slot it into their itinerary.

— Principles derived from the insight

- **Show time, not inventory** — arrival, dinner, a morning walk in the park: the chronological stay becomes the basic post shape
- **Remove transit anxiety first** — travel time and route from airport and station accompany every concept
- **Make content worth saving** — model itineraries and map-like carousels give a reason to return later
- **Put words to the calm** — the contrast with Tokyo's intensity is a strong hook for international audiences

These are behavioural hypotheses. Save rate, profile visits and link taps — currently NOT AVAILABLE — would test them within 30 days once Insights are shared.

CHAPTER 06

TRAVELER QUESTIONS

Content is designed as answers to real questions

The questions international travellers need answered before booking become the starting point of content design. Each question maps to a format (details in Chapter 10).

Traveller question	Form of the answer
How long from Narita Airport? Is it manageable with luggage?	Access Reel + save-worthy carousel (Concept 1)
What do I see from the room? What are mornings like?	Room and view Reels / carousels (Concepts 2, 6)
Why stay outside Tokyo at all?	"Beyond Tokyo" editorial content (Concept 3)
Can I take my first day in Japan slowly?	A first-day itinerary model (Concept 4)
What is there to do nearby? Is getting around easy?	Chiba by monorail — a model route (Concept 5)
Where do I eat? Is there local food?	On-site dining and local venues (Concept 7)
Is one night enough? Is a second night worth it?	Two-night model itinerary (Concepts 8, 10)
Can I align my stay with an event?	Regular event-linked plan posts (Concept 9)

This list is an initial hypothesis built from public information and general booking behaviour; it should be maintained continuously from real enquiries, reviews and search behaviour.

CHAPTER 07

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Define the yardstick before comparing

The competitive set is wider than "hotels in Chiba City". Inside a traveller's itinerary, the same single night is contested by Narita-area hotels, Tokyo design hotels and Boso resorts.

Category	What it means to the traveller
Narita-area hotels	Arrival / departure convenience; the direct rival for pre- and post-flight nights
Tokyo design hotels	Brand and urban experience, at a higher price point
Chiba City properties	Proximity rivals for event and business demand
Boso-area resorts	The alternative when the goal is nature and quiet

— Audit method (proposal)

- Select two to three accounts per category and record cadence, format mix, reactions and language coverage monthly, from public data
- Use the same yardstick as this document (average likes, format mix, event linkage)
- Treat competitors' numbers as design references, never as proof of their business results

> This document deliberately publishes no competitor figures. Placing unverified numbers in a sales document would violate the data principles set out in Chapter 02 and the Appendix. An audit, once run, will be appended with retrieval dates and sources.

The differentiator: a location beside Chiba Park and a "calm, design-led" experience overlap with none of the categories above. The conclusion of the comparison is not posting volume — it is how concretely this unique asset is converted into itinerary-ready imagery.

CHAPTER 08

INSTAGRAM STRATEGY

One system, from analysis to measurement

01 ANALYZE

Audit public data, competitors and traveller questions on a cycle

02 STRATEGY

Articulate the base positioning and target audiences

03 CONTENT

Produce through five pillars and repeatable formats (Ch. 9–10)

04 AUTOMATION

Use AI to speed production, analysis and reporting (Ch. 17)

05 MEASUREMENT

Verify with KPIs and feed learning into the next cycle (Ch. 14–15)

— Three principles

- **From notices to proposals** — plans are presented inside a picture of the stay, never as bare price and facility information
- **Repeatable formats** — the proven event-linked format becomes a system tied to the local events calendar
- **Measurable operations** — time, format and theme are logged for every post so owner metrics can be matched and verified

— Funnel design

Stage	Content that carries it
Discovery	Reels (non-follower reach) and area-experience content
Interest	Save-worthy model itineraries and carousels
Consideration	Concrete access, room and food information; curated Highlights
Booking	Profile booking path and plan-linked posts

Stage metrics are defined in Chapter 14. Stage-level figures are currently NOT AVAILABLE, so this chapter presents design only.

CHAPTER 09

CONTENT PILLARS

Five fixed formats, so production never starts from a blank page

PILLAR 1 — Hotel Experience

Rooms, views, balconies and the sauna. The property itself, shown through the guest's eyes and the flow of a day.

PILLAR 2 — Chiba Discovery

Chiba Park, the monorail and neighbourhood walks. Editorial content that starts at the hotel and opens up the area.

PILLAR 3 — Local Food

On-site dining (Komuna) and local venues. Food is the most language-independent and shareable theme.

PILLAR 4 — Narita to Chiba

Airport routing and how to spend pre- and post-flight nights. Practical content that removes the international traveller's biggest anxiety.

PILLAR 5 — Two-night Experience

A two-night model combining the hotel with area experiences — the core of this strategy's revenue hypothesis (Chapter 18), converting one-night demand into longer stays. Pillar weights are validated in operation; Pillars 2 and 5 are recommended heavier at the start.

CHAPTER 10

TEN CONTENT CONCEPTS

Each concept ships with a format and a call to action

#	Concept	Format	Purpose	CTA
1	30 Minutes from Narita	Reel + Carousel	Remove arrival-day anxiety	Save it to your itinerary
2	A Room Facing the Park	Reel	Sell the view and the calm	Go to room pages
3	Beyond Tokyo	Carousel	Declare the positioning	Follow for the Chiba series
4	Your First Night in Japan	Reel	Model an arrival-day stay	Go to the pre-flight plan
5	Chiba by Monorail	Carousel	Make the area concrete	Save (model route)
6	A Slow Morning	Reel	Park and breakfast atmosphere	Go to the two-night plan
7	Taste of Chiba	Reel + Carousel	Food's shareability	Go to dining information
8	Two Nights, Two Experiences	Carousel	Make the second night valuable	Go to the two-night plan
9	Event Weekend	Reel + Stories	Repeat the proven event format	Date-led booking prompt
10	Save This Chiba Itinerary	Carousel	Maximise save rate	Save + follow

Concept titles are set in English as the master form, with Japanese support lines in the Japanese edition (Chapter 13). Time and distance claims are re-verified against primary sources before publication.

CHAPTER 11

30-DAY OPERATING PLAN

Run in the smallest verifiable unit

— Base cadence

Reels	3 / week
Carousels	1 / week
Stories	4–5 days / week

— Posting-time test

Candidate windows: 7–9 a.m., the 12 p.m. hour, and 8–10 p.m. Reactions are logged per window alongside the move away from overnight slots. No "best time" is asserted; 30 days of data decide (Chapter 15).

— Conversation design

Against a baseline of one comment in 90 days, question-led captions and Stories polls / question stickers are built into the weekly rhythm.

Week	Theme	Key actions
Week 1	Baseline & access	Start Insights sharing; publish Concepts 1 and 4; fix the profile booking path
Week 2	Rooms & the park	Publish Concepts 2 and 6; format the view and the morning as repeatable shapes
Week 3	Local food & area	Publish Concepts 5 and 7; trial cross-posting with local venues
Week 4	Save-worthy itineraries & review	Publish Concepts 8 and 10; 30-day report and lessons for the next cycle

Thirty days is one verification cycle, not a promise period. At the end, we decide which concepts continue, which stop, and which metrics to add.

CHAPTER 12

CREATIVE DIRECTION

Unified by the grammar of high-end travel editorial



— Visual principles

- **Natural light first** — shoot morning and evening to show the passage of time
- Palette discipline: **deep greens, wood textures, neutrals**; no over-saturation
- Mix empty scenery with the guest's viewpoint — window seats, terraces, the table
- Large serif headlines, readable sans body text, generous white space

— The Reel format

- First three seconds state place and promise (e.g., "30 minutes from Narita", "a room facing the park")
- One theme per Reel; detail is delegated to the save-worthy carousel
- English captions as the base, designed to carry a Japanese support line (Chapter 13)

Images shown are concept visuals prepared for this project; in live operation they are replaced by the property's own photography.

CHAPTER 13

INTERNATIONAL COMMUNICATION

English as the master form; Japanese as the line of discovery

— Language design

- Captions lead in English; Japanese follows as support, with no gap in information content
- Proper nouns (YohaS, Chiba Park, etc.) appear in romanisation with a short English gloss
- Once priority markets are validated (Chapter 04), additional languages such as Traditional Chinese are phased in

— Main message

Beyond Tokyo. Discover Chiba.

Chiba is presented as a discovery inside the itinerary — not as a rejection of Tokyo, but as a widening of the trip.

— Operational notes

- Times, prices and transport must be equally accurate in English; re-verify against primary sources before publishing
- Prioritise concrete stay information — calm, greenery, food, access — over generic "Japanese-ness"
- Prepare an English response flow for comments and DMs, and feed questions back into the Chapter 06 list

Effects of international communication (reach by country, etc.) are verified through Insights audience data. With that data currently NOT AVAILABLE, no language-level results are asserted.

CHAPTER 14

KPI FRAMEWORK

"Becoming measurable" is itself the first KPI

Metric	What it shows	Cadence	Status
Non-follower reach	Discovery spread	Per post / weekly	NOT AVAILABLE — starts when Insights are shared
Reel views & avg. watch time	Hook strength and completion quality	Per post	NOT AVAILABLE
Save rate & share rate	Itinerary value	Per post / monthly	NOT AVAILABLE
Profile visits	Movement into consideration	Weekly	NOT AVAILABLE
Outbound link taps	Entry to the booking path	Weekly	NOT AVAILABLE
Follower change	Accumulating interest	Weekly / monthly	NOT AVAILABLE (point value 2,234 confirmed)
Likes & comments	Reaction visible in public data	Per post	PUBLIC DATA — avg. likes 25.7 (90 days)
Completed bookings	Business outcome (where measurable)	Monthly	Decided once tracking is designed

Numeric targets are set only after a baseline exists (the first 30 days). This document places no target figures without a basis.

CHAPTER 15

MEASUREMENT METHOD

Three layers of record: per post, weekly, monthly

Per post (each time)

Format, pillar (Ch. 9), concept number, posting time and 48-hour reaction. Likes and comments are trackable from public data alone.

Weekly (review)

Reach, saves, profile visits and follower change; progress notes on the posting-time test.

Monthly (decide)

Compare pillars, refresh the competitor audit (Ch. 7), and decide what changes in next month's concepts.

— Posting-time test design

Against the observed fact that 14 of 26 posts went out between 1 and 5 a.m. PUBLIC DATA, three candidate windows are tested in turn: 7–9 a.m., the 12 p.m. hour, and 8–10 p.m. Each window gets at least four posts, with format and theme logged separately. No "best time" is claimed until the data says so.

— Recording principles

- Always note retrieval date and source
- Never mix public data with owner-only metrics
- Separate correlation from causation (the overnight-posting effect is unproven)
- Log underperforming posts at the same granularity as successful ones

CHAPTER 16

STRATEGIC DECISIONS

What was chosen — and what was deliberately not chosen

Decision	Chosen	Not chosen — and why
What is sold	A stay in Chiba, not a room	Price-and-facility competition cannot use the property's unique assets
Position	A base between Narita, Tokyo and Boso	The "hotel in Chiba" frame misses itinerary-driven demand
Content investment	Save-worthy itineraries and event linkage, weighted heavier	Volume of announcements — the reaction data does not support it
Language	English as master, expanded in phases	Simultaneous multilingual rollout adds load before anything is validated
Handling of numbers	Unavailable metrics are labelled as such	Results expressed through estimates would destroy the document's credibility
Target setting	After the baseline exists	Baseless numeric targets distort operational judgement

CHAPTER 17

AI WORKFLOW

AI raises the speed of production and analysis; humans keep judgement

Stage	What AI carries
Research	Aggregation support for public data, competitor public information, event listings
Planning	Concept volume against the pillars (Ch. 9), mapped to traveller questions
Production	First-draft captions (EN / JA), subtitle drafts, Reel structure drafts
Analysis	Per-post aggregation; comparison tables by time window and format
Reporting	Weekly / monthly report scaffolding and drafting support for lessons learned

— Boundaries in operation

- Interpretation of numbers and strategic judgement stay with humans; AI output is never written up as results as-is
- Facts — property details, prices, transport — are verified against primary sources even in AI-drafted text
- No customer or booking information is entered into AI tools; only public information and aggregates are handled

This case study itself was produced through this workflow — public-data aggregation, strategy design, documentation — as a working example.

CHAPTER 18

BUSINESS IMPACT

Everything here is a hypothesis to be tested HYPOTHESIS

This chapter contains no results. The items below are business hypotheses to be tested over 30–90 days of operation. Nothing here guarantees, or reports, growth in revenue or bookings.

Hypothesis	Verification metrics	Method
Save-worthy content grows the consideration pool	Save rate; profile-visit trend	Compare Concepts 5, 8, 10 against others (Ch. 15 records)
Two-night propositions lengthen stays	Link taps and booking mix for the two-night plan	Track Pillar 5 posts against the booking path (where measurable)
Event linkage creates new reach	Non-follower reach; follower change	Weekly comparison of event vs. non-event periods
English communication reaches international considerers	Audience geography in Insights	Monthly attribute review; revisit Chapter 04 priorities
Better posting times improve reaction	Reaction by time window (likes, reach)	Chapter 15 posting-time test

A serious discussion of business impact becomes possible only once the metrics exist. That is why the first step of this proposal is the start of measurement itself.

CHAPTER 19

SUMMARY

Facts, interpretation, next moves

— Confirmed facts PUBLIC DATA

- 2,234 followers / 56 posts at about six months from opening
- Last 90 days: 13 posts, average 25.7 likes, one comment in total
- The top reaction was an event-linked stay plan (154 likes)
- Over half of posts (14/26) were published between 1 and 5 a.m.

— Interpretation

- The structure rewards experience-linked proposals over announcements
- Conversation and saves are the bottleneck for the next stage of growth
- The unique assets are Chiba Park's greenery and the calm, design-led stay

— Next moves

- Rebuild communication around the base positioning
- Start the ten concepts and the 30-day plan
- Begin measurement through Insights sharing and verify at day 30

Transferability: this system — audit, strategy, concepts, measurement — is designed as a reusable sales foundation for other hotels, ryokan and tourism properties (the Instagram Marketing System).

CHAPTER 20

CONCLUSION

Closing

What the TSUBAKIMORI account lacks is not posting volume.
It is a design that places "time spent in Chiba" inside the traveller's itinerary.

The public data showed a quiet plateau after the opening momentum — and, in the same data, a proven format in event linkage and an asset no competitor shares in Chiba Park. This case study's proposal turns that format and that asset into a system across four layers: positioning, content, operations and measurement.

The document is also an exercise in drawing lines: between numbers obtained and numbers unavailable, between facts and hypotheses. That discipline is what makes a sales document credible to international clients.

Beyond Tokyo. Discover Chiba.

APPENDIX

AUDIT NOTES

Sources, limitations and independence

— Sources and scope

- Retrieved 30 October 2026: public profile and 26 retrievable public posts (6 May – 25 Oct 2026)
- Of 56 total posts, 26 were analysed; the sample covers all posts in the last-90-day window (1 Aug – 30 Oct)
- Like and comment counts are cumulative values at retrieval time

— Metrics that could not be obtained

Reach, impressions, video views, saves, shares, follower change, audience demographics, active hours, profile visits and link taps are visible only in the account owner's Insights. No estimates have been substituted for them anywhere in this document.

— About the images

The cover and in-text images include concept visuals prepared for this project; they are not official property photography. In live use and publication, they are to be replaced or verified with the property's own photography and primary information.

— Independence statement

This document is an independent portfolio concept analysis based on public information. It was not commissioned, supervised or approved by the property, and it does not represent official account management results or any record of revenue or booking growth. Property details, prices, transport, facilities, partnerships and event information should be re-verified against primary sources before publication.

— Selected references

Official site	tsubakimori-hotel.com
Instagram	@the_tsubakimori_hotel
Booking.com	THE TSUBAKIMORI Hotel & Residence
Related release	Komuna STAY release (PR TIMES, Japanese)

PREPARED BY

HATTORI ICHIDAI

ATLAS TO PARADISE

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